

PREMIUM GUIDE

UNIVERSITY OF ILLINOIS URBANA-CHAMPAIGN

Complete Admission Guide for Indian Students

Programs, Fees, Scholarships, Placements & Campus Life

Urbana-Champaign, Illinois

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1. University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign at a Glance

#64
QS RANKING

1867
FOUNDED

56,000
STUDENTS

2,500+
INDIAN STUDENTS

93%
PLACEMENT RATE

Attribute	Details
Full Name	University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
Location	Urbana-Champaign, Illinois, USA
Type	Public (Est. 1867)
Acceptance Rate	45%
Student-Faculty Ratio	21:1
Graduation Rate	85%
International Students	20%
Gender Ratio	47:53 (F:M)
Website	illinois.edu
Motto	Top 5 Engineering — 2,500+ Indian Students

UIUC is a public land-grant research university and one of the top engineering schools in the world. With 2,500+ Indian students, it has one of the largest Indian communities among US universities. The Grainger College of Engineering is ranked top 5 nationally.

Notable Alumni

Marc Andreessen — Co-creator of Mosaic browser, founder of Netscape

Max Levchin — Co-founder of PayPal

2. Why Choose University?

- QS #64 — top 40 in the world for engineering
- 2,500+ Indian students — vibrant Indian community
- Grainger College of Engineering ranked top 5 in the US
- Top 5 in Computer Science — birthplace of Mosaic browser
- Affordable tuition with strong ROI
- Direct recruiting from Google, Meta, Amazon, NVIDIA

| Academic Environment

Rigorous and research-intensive. UIUC's engineering program is one of the best in the world. The CS department is particularly competitive. The academic culture is collaborative — students help each other succeed. Research funding is abundant.

| Student Life

Urbana-Champaign is a true college town — everything revolves around the university. The Indian community is large and well-organised. Green Street is the social hub. The campus has 1,000+ student organisations, so there's something for everyone.

3. Programs & Courses

Popular Programs for Indian Students

Program	Level	Duration	Tuition	Highlights
MS in Computer Science	PG	2 Years	\$30K-35K/yr	Top 5 CS program. Strengths in systems, AI, scientific computing, and programming languages.
MS in Electrical & Computer Engineering	PG	2 Years	\$30K-35K/yr	Top 4 ECE program. VLSI, signal processing, power systems, and controls.
MS in Mechanical Engineering	PG	2 Years	\$30K-35K/yr	Top 8 ME program with robotics, fluid dynamics, and materials science.
MS in Civil Engineering	PG	2 Years	\$28K-33K/yr	Top 2 Civil Engineering program. Structural, transportation, and environmental engineering.

4. Eligibility & Requirements

Admission Requirements

Requirement	Details
GPA	7.5+ (First Class)
GRE	310+ (325+ for CS)
IELTS	6.5+ (7.0+ recommended)
TOEFL	90+ (100+ recommended)
Work Experience	Not required
LORs	3 LORs
SOP	Required (strong research interests)
Resume	Required
Interview	Not required
Application Fee	\$90

5. Application Deadlines

Intake	Deadline	Decision Date
Fall (Aug)	Dec 15 (priority)	Mar 1
Spring (Jan)	Oct 1	Nov 1

6. Tuition & Cost of Living

Expense Category	Cost
Tuition (MS)	\$28,000-35,000/yr
Accommodation	\$7,000-13,000/yr
Food	\$4,000-6,000/yr
Transport	\$500/yr
Health Insurance	\$2,500/yr
Personal	\$3,000-5,000/yr

7. Scholarships & Funding

Scholarship	Amount	Eligibility	Deadline
Illinois Engineering Fellowship	\$5,000-20,000/yr	Merit-based for engineering graduate students	Rolling
TA/RA Positions	Full tuition waiver + \$1,800/mo stipend	Graduate students with teaching/research skills	Rolling

8. Placements & Career Outcomes

93% PLACEMENT RATE	\$105,000 AVG SALARY	\$220,000 HIGHEST SALARY	700+ COMPANIES
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Post-Study Work Pathway

OPT → H-1B → Green Card | Work visa duration: 3 years (STEM OPT)

9. Campus Life for Indians

Aspect	Details
Indian Association	UIUC Indian Students Association — 400+ members
Accommodation	On-campus housing + off-campus apartments in Campustown
Avg Rent	\$600-1,100/month
Indian Food	Dosology, Himalayan Restaurant, Indian grocery stores on Green Street
Weather	Cold winters (-8°C), hot humid summers (30°C). Midwest weather.
Transport	Free campus bus (MTD) + Champaign-Urbana public transit
Healthcare	McKinley Health Center (on-campus)
Safety	Very safe campus. Low crime rate.

Nightlife & Social Scene

Campustown bars on Green Street. KAM's and Joe's Brewery are legendary. House parties in the neighbourhoods near campus.

Student Clubs & Societies

- **Indian Students Association** — Cultural
- **UIUC Cricket Club** — Sports
- **Bharat (Cultural)** — Cultural
- **ACM @ UIUC** — Tech
- **Women in CS** — Tech
- **Entrepreneurship Society** — Professional

11. What Students Say

"Top 5 CS at public school prices. I got offers from Google and Meta before I even graduated."

— Rohan, MS CS '24

"2,500 Indians means I found a cricket team, a Bollywood dance group, and a study group in my first week."

— Karan, MS ECE '25

"The Grainger College has more resources than I could ever use. Research funding is everywhere."

— Priya, MS ME '24

Your University Journey Starts Here

Get expert guidance on your University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign application — SOP review, LOR templates, visa prep, and more.

www.kohortconnect.com

